



OXFORD JOURNALS
OXFORD UNIVERSITY PRESS

Review

Reviewed Work(s): *The Managed Heart: Commercialization of Human Feeling.* by Arlie Russell Hochschild

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Source: *Social Forces*, Sep., 1985, Vol. 64, No. 1 (Sep., 1985), pp. 223-224

Published by: Oxford University Press

Stable URL: <https://www.jstor.org/stable/2578990>

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of the work of Karl Polanyi; and an over-condensed summary of Douglass North's recent book on institutional change. This book will not make dedicated cultural determinists espouse rational choice models, since they are as stubborn in their preferences as materialists. At a minimum, however, the essays by Hechter, Brinton, and Brustein should be read by those interested in developing economic models of social behavior.

The Managed Heart: Commercialization of Human Feeling.

By Arlie Russell Hochschild. University of California Press, 1983. 307 pp. \$14.95.

Reviewer: JULIE V. BROWN, University of North Carolina at Greensboro

Arlie Hochschild's newest book is devoted to an examination of the management of human emotions. In an insightful analysis, she exposes the social underpinnings of the most "private" of feelings. She also catalogues the costs to workers of employment that demands a high degree of "emotional labor."

The first part of the book "describes the workings of an emotional system in normal private life." Relying largely on data collected from students at Berkeley, Hochschild discusses the extent to which individuals in their daily lives attempt to regulate their feelings in accordance with what she terms "feeling rules." Appropriate expression of emotion is an integral component of human social interaction. Each culture includes an elaborate set of rules by which the social exchange of sentiments is regulated. Those "feeling rules" inform us when, where, and how we should feel.

The effort expended to produce expected feelings is referred to by Hochschild as "emotion work." This work frequently involves more than the superficial display of emotion ("surface acting"). At a funeral one is not merely expected to appear sad, one should actually experience grief. The latter may require "deep acting," through which one produces the desired emotional state. In other words, "we make feigning easy by making it unnecessary."

Both surface acting and deep acting require exertion, although the amount of effort differs. This emotional labor has always been a part of private human exchanges. In Part Two of her book Hochschild describes what happens "when deep and surface acting are forms of labor to be sold and when private capacities for empathy and warmth are put to corporate uses." Many service occupations call for a great amount of emotional labor, but this dimension of work has been largely ignored. Hochschild scrutinizes two occupations that exemplify the extremes to which employers' demands for emotional labor can be taken: the flight attendant and the bill collector (or, in her words, the "toe and the heel of capitalism").

Hochschild's most detailed analysis is devoted to flight attendants. Lengthy observation of training programs and interviews with individuals at all levels in a major airline company allow her to paint a vivid picture of what that work is like. The picture is one of intense and rigidly supervised emotional labor. The flight attendant is told how to *feel* toward passengers, and her performance is carefully monitored. Consequently, she is alienated from her own emotional labor. Her feelings have become a commodity, purchased by the employer and used to generate profit.

Hochschild contends that the personal costs of such work are high. This is due in large part to the fact that emotions serve a "signal function," helping us to locate ourselves in the world. When people become estranged from their feelings they lose this signal function. Hochschild found that some stewardesses "burned out" (i.e., lost the capacity to feel); others saw themselves as "phonies."

Hochschild also discusses how emotion management varies with gender and social class. That higher status entitles one to more respect for one's feelings is by no means a new observation. What Hochschild does very nicely is to analyze the implications of that fact for women in jobs that require a great deal of emotional labor. Women do much more of this sort of work than men, and even when both work at the same job it "is one sort of job for a woman and another sort of job for a man."

One of the briefest (and, to me, least satisfying) sections of the book discusses the role of the family in socialization for emotional labor. The discussion begins with a broad generalization: "Big emotion workers tend to raise little ones." That is followed by a not terribly convincing attempt to relate the literature on class differences in socialization to differences in various occupations' requirements for emotional labor.

On the whole, this is a superb book. Hochschild has tackled a heretofore largely ignored dimension of human social existence. In the process she shows it to be important for understanding work, inequalities of gender and class, and (as she suggests in her final chapter) our current obsession with "unmanaged feelings." I recommend this book highly.

The Soap Opera

By Muriel G. Cantor and Suzanne Pingree. Sage, 1983. 167 pp. Cloth, \$29.95; paper, \$9.95.

Creating Media Culture.

By Robert P. Snow. Sage, 1983. 263 pp. Cloth, \$25.00; paper, \$12.50.

Reviewer: BRIAN KAHIN, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

These two books about media treat the interaction of production, content, and format. Muriel Cantor and Suzanne Pingree take a close look at a classical genre that has migrated from radio to television; Robert Snow takes in everything from newspapers and novels to radio, television, and film. They share a common concern for studying institutions and processes as a whole, and in this respect embody the practical orientation and worldliness of much contemporary social research. Beyond this, however, the two works are very different.

Cantor and Pingree construct a comprehensive picture of the soap opera that begins by tracing its origins in the domestic novel. They relate the history of early soap opera—the daytime serials on network radio, which set the pattern for the television soap opera. An account of current industry practices is followed by a discussion of content, which marshals and reviews research in the area. The authors draw particular attention to the relation of soap opera content to prime-time television and television as a whole. A chapter is devoted to original research: